

Admin guide

Admins can do everything a manager can, plus manage **users**, **services**, the **sidebar (Menu Controller)**, the **audit log**, and **backups**.

Admins must use **Two-Factor Authentication** — see [Getting Started](#).

1. Users — add and manage staff

Public sign-up is disabled, so **you create every staff account**.

- **Users** → **Add user** → name, email, **role**, and a temporary password.

Leave **Active** ticked.

- Give the person their email + temporary password; they change it on first login. Admins/managers will be guided through 2FA setup.

- **Edit** a user to change their name, email, role, or reset their password.
- **When someone leaves:** edit them and **untick Active** instead of deleting —

this blocks their login but keeps their leads, deals and history intact.

- You **can't** disable, demote, or delete **your own** account (so you can't lock yourself out).

Roles available:

Role	What they can access
Admin	Everything, including users, menu controller, audit log, backups
Manager	All modules except user/menu/audit/backup admin
Sales	Leads, deals, their own clients, quotations, projects, tasks, tickets, calls
Support	Tickets, projects (assigned), clients (read-only), calls, tasks
Accounts	Invoices, payments, clients, recurring invoices
Intern	Clients (read-only), Projects (assigned), Tasks (assigned), Attendance, Daily Reports

Biometric Device User ID: each user record has an optional

Biometric Device User ID field. Set this to the numeric ID from the eSSL attendance machine's Device Users list. Once set, punches from that person on the biometric machine automatically update their CRM attendance record (check-in and check-out times). See Section 1a below.

1a. Biometric attendance sync (eSSL machine)

The CRM is connected to the **eSSL x 2008** biometric attendance machine (serial NFZ8243301103). When staff punch in or out on the machine, their attendance is automatically synced to the CRM — no manual check-in needed.

How it works:

- The machine sends each punch to the CRM automatically via the internet.
- The **first punch of the day** sets the check-in time.
- The **last punch of the day** sets the check-out time.
- If a staff member also pressed the manual check-in button on the CRM

dashboard, the biometric punch will update the record with the exact time from the machine.

To map a staff member to the machine:

1. On the machine, go to **Menu** → **User Mgt** to find the person's numeric User ID (e.g. 1, 3, 13, 16 ...).
1. In the CRM, go to **Users** → **Edit** the staff member.
2. Enter that number in the **Biometric Device User ID** field and save.

From that point on, the machine's punches update their attendance automatically.

If the sync stops working, check that `BIOMETRIC_DEVICE_SERIAL` is set correctly in the server `.env` and run `php artisan config:cache`. The machine's Cloud Server settings should point to `crm.talktonitesh.com` on port 443 with HTTPS on.

Occasional missing punches: the biometric machine's own stored log can get trimmed during the day by other software that also reads it (the "hitech" billing software), so a punch can occasionally never reach the CRM at all. If someone's check-in or check-out looks wrong or missing on the Attendance page:

1. In **hitech**, open that staff member's **Attendance** tab, pick the date range, and click **Export To Excel**.
1. In the CRM, go to **Attendance** → **Import from Hitech**, pick the staff member, and upload that file.
1. Review the preview (it shows Hitech's times next to what the CRM currently has) and click **Import**. Only the fields Hitech actually reports are written — it never erases a value the CRM already has just because a cell is blank (e.g. someone who hasn't clocked out yet when the export was taken).

2. Services — the service-line taxonomy

Services lists your offerings (SEO, GMB, Website Development, Social Media, Google Ads, Software Development, AI Automation...). These power every report's service breakdown.

- **Add** a new service line, **rename**, set the **sort order**, or ****toggle active****.
- A service **in use** by leads/deals/projects/tickets can't be deleted — just deactivate it so it stays on old records but isn't offered for new ones.

3. Menu Controller — who sees what

The **Menu Controller** has two parts:

- **Role grid** — which roles can reach each module. *This controls real access.*
- **Per-user overrides** — show/hide individual sidebar items for one person.

Cosmetic only — it tidies someone's sidebar but does **not** grant or remove permission (that's always governed by roles). A banner on the page reminds you of this.

Changes apply on the user's next page load.

4. Clients — status, bulk import & deletion

Client status: clients have three statuses:

- **Prospect** (yellow) — created when a lead is converted. Not yet a paying client.
- **Active** (green) — promoted automatically when their deal is marked **Won**.
- **Inactive** — set manually when a relationship ends.

The Clients list defaults to showing Active clients. Use the status filter to view Prospects, Inactive, or all. You can also set the status manually on the client's edit page.

Import (Clients → Import): upload a CSV. The template (downloadable from the import page) has 13 columns including `address_line2`, `owner` (user's full name), and `tags` (comma-separated). Leave `owner` blank to assign the client to the importing user. Duplicate emails and GSTINs (including soft-deleted records) are skipped automatically.

Deleting a client: removes the client **and all related records** — deals, quotations, invoices, projects, tasks, tickets, contacts, notes, and call logs.

This cannot be undone. Use this only when the company record should be wiped entirely; consider making a client **Inactive** instead if you may need the history later.

5. WhatsApp integration

The CRM is connected to **wadesk.in** (your WhatsApp dashboard). When a client messages your WhatsApp support number with a **new conversation** (or reopens a resolved one), a support ticket is automatically created in the CRM.

- The ticket appears with a green **WhatsApp** badge on the Tickets list.
- If the client's phone number matches an existing client record, the ticket is linked to them. If no match is found, the ticket is still created (staff can link it to a client manually).
- Each conversation creates **one ticket** — subsequent messages in the same conversation don't create duplicates.
- Staff reply to the client from **wadesk.in** directly. Replies can also be logged as ticket notes in the CRM to keep the record complete.

This integration is configured via `COMPANY_WHATSAPP` and `WHATSAPP_WEBHOOK_TOKEN`

in the server `.env` . Contact your developer if the integration stops creating tickets.

6. Scheduled maintenance tasks

The CRM runs `app:dispatch-scheduled-tasks` at **8 AM IST daily** via the cron scheduler. It scans every active project, matches it to a set of built-in task templates by service, and creates tasks due today — assigned to the project lead with an in-app bell notification.

No configuration is needed — templates are built into the command and cover all NEDS service lines (Website Dev, SEO, GMB, Social Media, Google Ads, etc.).

Backfill a missed date (e.g. server was down, or a project was just made active):

```
```bash
php artisan app:dispatch-scheduled-tasks --date=2026-07-01
```
```

The command is idempotent — running it twice for the same date will not create duplicate tasks.

Verify it ran: open any active project in Emptask and check that tasks were created today. Or check the server cron log.

7. NEDS tool integrations (Drishti & SMDost)

The CRM is connected to **nedsdrishti.in** and **socialmediadost.com**. Seven automated workflows run between the three tools. The full details are in the [Integrations guide](#). In summary:

| When this happens in CRM | This happens automatically |
|--|---|
| Deal marked Won | Client + user created in Drishti and SMDost |
| Brief fully approved in SMDost | Draft invoice created in CRM; accounts notified |
| Content piece marked Send to agency in SMDost | *NEDS-led* content piece auto-created in CRM project (status: *Sent to partner*), pre-filled with copy text |
| Drishti post approved/published | Activity logged on the client's CRM timeline |
| 1st of the month (7:30 AM) | Monthly content briefs auto-created in SMDost |
| Client opens portal SSO button | One-click login to Drishti or SMDost |
| WhatsApp ticket opened | Drishti context link auto-appended to ticket |

Keeping integrations healthy: all events leave a trace in the client's Activity feed. If an integration stops working, the most common fix is verifying the server `.env` keys (`DRISHTI_SERVICE_KEY` , `SMDOST_SERVICE_KEY` , `PORTAL_SSO_SECRET`) and running `php artisan config:cache` . See the [Integrations guide](#) for step-by-step troubleshooting.

8. Website lead capture

The **niranjanenterprises.com** contact form automatically creates a lead in the CRM whenever someone submits it. No manual action is needed.

- New leads land in **Lead Generation** with source **Website** and status **New**, unassigned.
- Assign them to a sales person as soon as possible so the enquiry doesn't sit cold.
- The message the visitor typed appears in the lead's **Notes** tab.
- Service and company fields are captured when the visitor fills them in.

This integration is configured once on the server (a secret token in `.env`).

You don't need to touch anything — if the contact form stops creating leads, check that the server's `LEAD_CAPTURE_TOKEN` matches what's configured in the Elementor webhook URL.

9. Partners — content agency directory

Partners in the sidebar is a directory of the external content agencies NEDS collaborates with. Managers and admins can add, edit, and delete partner records.

Each partner needs only a **name**. Email and phone are optional but useful for quick reference when you need to contact the agency.

Once a partner is registered, staff can assign them to content pieces inside projects (see [Manager guide → Content collaboration](#)).

Deleting a partner is allowed only when no content pieces are linked to them — the CRM will block the delete and show an error if any pieces still reference that partner.

10. Audit Log

Audit Log (admin) shows who created, updated or deleted records, and when. Filter by record type or event. Use it to investigate "who changed this?".

11. Backups

The database is **backed up automatically every night at 2 AM** (kept 14 daily + 8 weekly copies on the server). You don't need to do anything. To restore from a backup, follow [docs/backup-restore.md](#).

12. AI features (optional)

Three AI helpers are built into the CRM, powered by Anthropic's Claude. They are **off by default** and never take action automatically — they only assist staff.

Lead scoring — when a lead is created or edited, the CRM automatically sends its details to Claude and stores a **0–100 score** with a one-line reason (e.g. "Specific service requested, phone and company provided — high intent").

The score badge appears on the leads list so sales staff can prioritise without reading every entry. Existing leads (created before AI was enabled) get scored the next time they are edited and saved.

Draft follow-up / Draft reply (✨) — a button on leads and tickets. When clicked, Claude reads the lead/ticket details and history, then writes a suggested message. The staff member edits it and sends it themselves. Claude never sends anything automatically.

Summarize — a button on client pages and tickets. Claude reads the full timeline (notes, calls, interactions) and produces a short paragraph summarising the situation. Useful when picking up a colleague's account.

To turn on: add these two lines to the server `.env` , then run

```
php artisan config:cache :  
...  
  
AI_ENABLED=true  
ANTHROPIC_API_KEY=sk-ant-...  
...
```

If the features are off, the buttons simply don't appear and nothing else changes. Usage is billed by Anthropic per request (very low cost for this volume).

Tip

Adding a new module/menu item or changing a label is a code change that deploys automatically — but the menu lives in the database, so after such a change the menu must be re-seeded on the server (`php artisan db:seed --class=MenuItemsSeeder --force`).